

Wayve

Embodied AI / Autonomous Driving · London, UK · Private (~\$8.6B; \$1.2B Series D, Feb 2026)

Wayve - Britain's embodied-AI leader for autonomous driving, valued at \$8.6B after a \$1.2B Series D in February 2026 - is the rare brand whose 'future of mobility' story is native to Formula E, with no autonomy or mobility-AI brand anywhere on the grid.

73

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

WARM

SERIES

FE

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Envision Racing

ACTION HORIZON

8-12 WKS

THE CASE

Wayve is the UK's embodied-AI champion for autonomous driving: founded in 2017 by CEO Alex Kendall, it raised a \$1.2B Series D in February 2026 (about \$1.5B including Uber's milestone tranche) at an \$8.6B valuation, backed by SoftBank, Nvidia, Microsoft and Uber alongside automakers Mercedes-Benz, Nissan and Stellantis. It is launching a London Uber robotaxi service in 2026 and supervised-autonomy software in consumer vehicles from 2027. For Formula E - the championship that exists to tell the future-of-electric-mobility story - an autonomous-mobility-AI brand is an unusually native fit, and no autonomy or mobility-AI brand holds an FE partnership. The honest counterweight: Wayve's customers are automakers, reached through industry channels, so a motorsport play is a brand, innovation-narrative and recruiting halo (it is in a fierce AI talent war), not a B2B-pipeline channel.

WHY NOW

Wayve is freshly capitalized (\$1.2B in Feb 2026) and scaling fast into commercial robotaxi launches - a brand-building inflection where a young, recruiting-hungry AI company invests in identity and talent visibility. The autonomy/mobility lane on the FE grid is empty, so moving now secures a clean, native category before a peer notices it.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

~\$8.6B

Valuation (Series D, 25 Feb 2026)

\$1.2B

Series D raise (~\$1.5B incl. Uber milestone tranche)

Alex Kendall

Co-founder & CEO (since 2017)

auto + big tech

Strategic investors incl. automakers Mercedes-Benz, Nissan, Stellantis (+ Nvidia, Microsoft, Uber, SoftBank)

2026-27 rollout

London Uber robotaxi launch 2026; consumer supervised-autonomy from 2027

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE FE GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

Envision Racing	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
Andretti	CROWDED	TWG AI, Quest Global, NAGASE
Porsche	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Jaguar TCS Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

A British embodied-AI champion (\$8.6B, fresh off a \$1.2B Series D) whose autonomous-mobility story maps onto Formula E's 'future of mobility' identity better than almost any brand - and no autonomy/mobility-AI brand is on the grid. The honest caveat: its buyers are automakers, so this is a brand/innovation/recruiting halo, not a B2B-pipeline play.

FUNDING EVENT

NEVER ENTERED

CATEGORY WHITESPACE

DISCOVERY: SELF

WHY ENVISION RACING

Envision Racing - a sustainability-first independent with a clean (greenfield) partner roster - is the conflict-free fit for Wayve's clean-mobility-and-autonomy story, with room to own the lane outright. HONEST NOTE: this is the cleanest available FE team because our own pipeline has now filled the premium FE slots (Nissan, Mahindra, Jaguar, Porsche, Andretti). The strongest *warm-path* alternative is Nissan, which is an existing Wayve investor - a real relationship hook - but Nissan already carries a 1440 enterprise-AI prospect (Cohere), so Envision is the cleaner primary.

VALUE TO ENVISION RACING — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B. The value is a future-of-mobility brand association and an innovation/talent narrative, plus premium hospitality - not an in-car integration (FE cars are driver-raced). Envision gains a marquee embodied-AI partner that reinforces its sustainability-and-technology identity; Wayve gains a globally-broadcast, mobility-native stage to build its independent brand and recruit.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Official Mobility AI Partner tier on Envision Racing (Nissan as a warm-path alternative via its existing Wayve investment), minimum three years, ~\$3-5M/yr, with category exclusivity for autonomy/mobility-AI and a content/innovation-narrative programme aimed at talent and enterprise audiences.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Alex Kendall
CO-FOUNDER & CEO, WAYVE - VERIFIED

Alex Kendall co-founded Wayve in 2017 (Cambridge PhD, a pioneer of end-to-end 'AV2.0' learned driving) and serves as CEO, owning strategy, brand and the company's scale-up agenda - the right and direct entry point for a marquee brand decision. Co-decision-makers: the CFO/ commercial leadership steering the post-Series-D scale-up.

OPENING ANGLE

"Alex, Formula E exists to tell the future-of-mobility story - and Wayve is that story, yet no autonomy brand is on the grid. A British embodied-AI leader owning the lane, with a recruiting and innovation stage in front of the right audience. 25 minutes?"

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 16 / 20 Fresh \$1.2B Series D at an \$8.6B valuation (25 Feb 2026) and a 2026 London robotaxi launch - peak capital and brand momentum now.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$8.6B valuation, ~\$1.5B raised in Feb 2026 (with Uber's milestone tranche); an FE deal is immaterial.	BRAND FIT 15 / 20 Autonomous-mobility AI is an unusually clean fit for Formula E's future-of-mobility identity, and a British brand suits the championship - though as MODE B the value is a halo, not in-car tech.	URGENCY 12 / 20 Fresh capital and a recruiting land-grab in autonomy, but no dated external forcing function.	OPS FIT 12 / 20 MODE B: a mobility-innovation and talent-brand association, not an in-car system (FE cars are driver-raced, not autonomous).
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RISKS & COUNTERS

BUYERS ARE AUTOMAKERS, NOT THE PADDOCK Wayve sells AI to OEMs, so F1/FE hospitality doesn't reach its pipeline - the sponsorship logic is halo/recruiting, not B2B leads. **Counter:** Lead with brand-establishment, the talent war (autonomy recruiting is brutal) and the mobility-native narrative; keep it a relationship-and-halo play, modest and scalable.

AUTOMAKER-INVESTOR ENTANGLEMENT Nissan, Mercedes and Stellantis are investors, which could complicate an independent team choice. **Counter:** Recommend the conflict-free independent (Envision); if the team prefers, the Nissan investor relationship is a ready-made warm path instead.

SOURCES

- <https://www.cnn.com/2026/02/24/wayve-fundraise-nvidia-microsoft.html>
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